Xinyang Yu (于昕洋)

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EDUCATION

Social Genetic and Developmental Psychiatry Centre, King's College London — London, UK
PhD in Social Genetic and Developmental Psychiatry — *Oct 2021-Jul 2025*

Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences — Beijing, China
M.S. in Psychology, GPA: 3.73/4, Top 5% — *Sep 2018-Jul 2021*

Department of Clinical Medicine, Peking University — Beijing, China
B.S. in Medical Laboratory Technology, GPA: 3.52/4, Rank: 2/23 — *Sep 2014-Jul 2018*

School of Psychological and Cognitive Sciences, Peking University — Beijing, China
B.S. in Psychology, Double Major — *Sep 2015-Jul 2018*

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

04/2025 – present: Postdoctoral Research Associate, King's College London, PI: Sylvane Desrivières

PUBLICATIONS

Yu, X., Xiang, S., Jia, T., Zhang, Z., Sun, Y., Banaschewski, T., et al. (2026). BMI trajectories during adolescence: associations with brain maturation and DNA methylation. *Biological Psychiatry: Global Open Science*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bpsgos.2026.100820

Qian, L.#, Shi, R.#, **Yu, X.#**, Chen, D., Banaschewski, T., Barker, G. J., et al. (2026). Adolescent multi-omics and Mendelian randomization reveal transdiagnostic molecular mechanisms in psychiatric disorders. *Nature Mental Health*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44220-026-00660-2

Chen, D., **Yu, X.**, Cheng, W., Wang, L., Xiang, S., Zhang, W., et al. (2026). A longitudinal DNA methylation atlas and its link to brain structure and mental health. *Molecular Psychiatry*, 10.1038/s41380-026-03554-y. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41380-026-03554-y

Yu, X., Zhang, Z., Herle, M., Banaschewski, T., Barker, G. J., Bokde, A. L. W., et al. (2025). Relationships of eating behaviors with psychopathology, brain maturation and genetic risk for obesity in an adolescent cohort study. *Nature Mental Health, 3*(1), 58–70. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44220-024-00354-7

Yu, X., Robinson, L., Bobou, M., Zhang, Z., Banaschewski, T., Barker, G. J., et al. (2025). Multimodal investigations of structural and functional brain alterations in anorexia and bulimia nervosa and their relationships to psychopathology. *Biological psychiatry, 98*(3), 237–248. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsych.2024.11.008

Desrivières, S., Miller, A., Mathey, C.M., **Yu, X.**, Chen, D., Agunbiade, K., et al. Multi-omics analyses of the environMENTAL project provide insights into mental health and disease. *Nature Mental Health* 2, 1131–1133 (2024). https://doi.org/10.1038/s44220-024-00317-y

Yu, X., & Desrivières, S. (2023). Altered anticipatory brain responses in eating disorders: A neuroimaging meta-analysis. *European eating disorders review: the journal of the Eating Disorders Association, 31*(3), 363–376. https://doi.org/10.1002/erv.2967

Yu, X., Liao, K., Turetsky, B. I. & Wang, K. (2022). Semantic processing features and schizotypal traits: A test-retest study. *International journal of psychophysiology: official journal of the International Organization of Psychophysiology, 178*, 1–8. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijpsycho.2022.06.002

Yu, C.#, **Yu, X.#**, Fan, Z., Wang, K. & Littleton, H. (2022). Development and validation of a BMI-based figure rating scale for Chinese adolescents. *Evaluation & the health professions, 45*(2), 215–219. https://doi.org/10.1177/0163278720926714

Wang, K., **Yu, X.,** Yu, C., Liu, Y., Chu, M., Zhang, R., et al. (2022). Validation of the Chinese version of the body image concern inventory. *Evaluation & the health professions, 45*(2), 204–214. https://doi.org/10.1177/0163278720979651

Yu, X., Liao, K., Niu, Z., Wang, K., Cheung, E., Li, X. & Chan, R. (2020). Resting frontal EEG asymmetry and schizotypal traits: a test-retest study. *Cognitive neuropsychiatry, 25*(5), 333–347. https://doi.org/10.1080/13546805.2020.1800448

Wang, K., Liang, R., **Yu, X.**, Shum, D., Roalf, D & Chan, R. (2020). The thinner the better: Evidence on the internalization of the slimness ideal in Chinese college students. *PsyCh journal, 9*(4), 544–552. https://doi.org/10.1002/pchj.346

Yu, C., **Yu. X.,** Liang, R., Fan, Z., Wang, M., Wang, K. & Yang, X. (2020). Media image and body image in adolescents. *Chinese Journal of Health Management, 14*(02): 177-180. http://doi.org/10.3760/cma.j.cn115624-20191118-00500

Fan, Z., **Yu, X.**, Yu, C., Liang, R. & Wang, K. (2020). Weight control behaviors and their association with real and perceived weight status among 1,026 first year high school students in Lanzhou. *Chinese Journal of Child Health Care*. http://doi.org/10.11852/zgetbjz2019-1708

Yu, X., Tan, S., Wang, K. & Chan, R. C. (2019). A review of applications of resting-state electroencephalography in schizophrenia research. *Chinese Mental Health Journal, 33(*05): 349-354. http://doi.org/10.3969/j.issn.1000-6729.2019.05.006

Under review:

Yu, X., Desrivières, S., ENIGMA-Epigenetics Working Group, et al. Epigenetic signatures linking environmental exposure, cortical structure and psychiatric traits. https://www.researchsquare.com/article/rs-9151930/v1

Yu, X., Keeler, J., Robinson, L., Zhang, Z., Barker, G. J., Bokde, A. L. W., et al. Persistent suicidality and incomplete psychological recovery after remission of anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa.

Yu, X., Desrivières, S., ENIGMA-Epigenetics Working Group, et al. Epigenome-wide associations between DNA methylation, psychopathology, gene expression, and subcortical brain structure.

Chen, D., **Yu, X.**, Miller, A., Mathey, C.M., Forstner, A.J., Robinson, L., et al. The longitudinal epigenetic basis of major depressive disorder: insights into brain maturation and environmental influences.

Gruber, T., Chesters, R.A., Fagnocchi, L., **Yu, X.**, Fu, Z., Gallik, K., et al. Midbrain Tet1 dosage determines Binge-Eating Disorder vulnerability. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.03.14.711800

CONFERENCES

Yu, X. et al. (2026). The incomplete picture of ED recovery: What changes and what persists? *Oral presentation at the International Conference on Eating Disorders (ICED) in the Hague, Netherlands.*

Yu, X., Desrivières, S., on behalf of ENIGMA-Epigenetics Working Group. (2026). Peripheral blood DNA methylation signatures of cortical structure and their relevance to brain disorders. *Poster presentation at the Festival of Genomics & Biodata 2026 in London, UK.*

Desrivières, S., **Yu, X.** (2024). Epigenome-wide association studies identify biological mechanisms and genes conferring vulnerability to mental illness in adolescence. *Biological psychiatry, 95*(10): S57. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsych.2024.02.142

Yu, X. et al. (2023). Disordered eating behaviours and their relations to trajectories of internalising and externalising problems and brain development during adolescence. *Oral presentation at the International Conference on Eating Disorders (ICED) in Washington, District of Columbia, USA.*

Yu, X. et al. (2023). Epigenome-wide association studies as a tool to identify biological mechanisms and genes conferring vulnerability to mental health symptoms. *Poster presentation at the Epigenetic Inheritance symposium at Zurich, Switzerland.*

Yu, X., Liao, K., Wang, K. & Chan, R. C. (2019). The test-retest reliability of N400. *Proceedings of 22nd National Academic Congress of Psychology*.

Yu, X., Liao, K., Niu, Z., Wang, K., Li, X. & Chan, R. C. (2018). Correlation analysis of schizotypal traits and EEG power spectra in resting state. *Proceedings of 21st National Academic Congress of Psychology*.

RESEARCH SKILLS

Neuroimaging analyses: preprocessing and quality control of neuroimaging data, formal structural and functional MRI analysis, longitudinal neuroimaging analysis

Omics analyses: preprocessing and quality control of genotyping and DNA methylation data, genotype imputation, polygenic score calculation, genome-wide and epigenome-wide association analysis (GWAS and EWAS), meta-analysis, genomic structural equation modelling (genomic SEM), functional annotation, enrichment analysis, Mendelian randomisation, colocalisation analysis

Longitudinal data analyses: structural equation modelling (such as mixed growth curve modelling, latent growth curve modelling, latent class analysis, and factor analysis), mixed linear models, generalised additive models

Software and programming: Proficient in R, MATLAB (SPM12/CAT12), Python, PLINK, Mplus and STATA.

Teamwork and leadership: Strong experience in international and interdisciplinary research collaborations (across IMAGEN, STRATIFY and ESTRA consortia; ENIGMA-Epigenetics Working Group), led and conducted analyses across various cohorts, skilled in managing and analysing large-scale datasets

AWARDS

Best PhD Thesis Prize in 2025 at King's College London (500 GBP)
Early career researcher development fund at King's College London (500 GBP)
King's-China Scholarship Council PhD Scholarship (incl. full tuition fee and 75,000 USD; 2021-2025)
National Scholarship in China (3000 USD; awarded to top 5% students; 2019-2020)
First Prize Scholarship at IPCAS (1000 USD; awarded to top 10% students; 2018-2019)
Merit student at IPCAS (2018-2021)
Excellent Graduate (awarded to top 5% graduates; 2018)
Merit student at PKU (2014-2018)
Second Scholarship at PKU (800 USD; 2016-2018)

OTHER

Graduate teaching assistant (GTA) *Feb-Apr 2022*

- *Assisted in the Psychological Approaches to Treatment module, for Developmental Psychology and Psychopathology MSc*